BECOMING MORE EFFECTIVE IN LESS TIME

When Good is No Longer Good Enough

Shaun Crumméy

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Printed in the United States of America.

Dedication

This book is dedicated to all of those who are reading it right now in order to make a change in their lives, to all of the members of the Luhv+ Mailbox Millionaire Community, and to each and every entrepreneur and career professional who sees the importance of personal development.

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Introduction

Welcome to *Becoming More Effective in Less Time: When Good is No Longer Good Enough.* This book is for millennials, entrepreneurs, creatives, career professionals, and anyone who is ready to step into their own greatness. It is for those experiencing a shift in perspective—a shift in how they're thinking and how they're feeling. It's for those who feel those internal tremors whispering that there is something more to life than their current circumstances. They are right … and so are you.

People ask why I generally spell my name Shon Crú-May or the word "love" as "luhv" on my platform for millennials and entrepreneurs. And the more I thought about the answer, the more I found that it relates to all that I do, and specifically to this book. A phonetic spelling constitutes an alteration of an ordinary spelling that better represents the spoken language. *Why?* To make it clearer. As a firm believer in clarity, simplicity, and transparency, I chose the phonetic spelling of love. But this also applies to the premise of this book.

We all went through unprecedented uncertainty while navigating the first years of the COVID-19 pandemic. And we all needed some clarity and focus back in our

lives to move forward. Having the right mindset to become more effective in less time is all about getting clear—with yourself and your intentions. It's about finding the simplicity in understanding that you have everything you need to step into your own greatness and propel yourself to the next level—whatever that is for *you*.

Too often, we get caught up in the mindset of being good. And there is absolutely nothing wrong with living a good life … as long as it's authentic and we aren't just trying to pretend it's good. But what if there's more? What if we could be great and live a great life instead? What would that look like for you?

This hit me one night when I was lying in bed wondering what that little voice inside me kept trying to tell me—first as whispers, then as screams ringing in my ears. It was dark, and I was thinking of all of my blessings. Seriously, life was good, so what was my problem? Why wasn't I satisfied with what I had?

Then it hit me that being good was no longer *good enough* for me. I wanted to be great. I wanted to have a great life and I knew for sure that I deserved it. I stopped feeling badly for wanting to pivot my life into something more. I finally realized that I was so busy being good that I forgot to be great.

Once again, this is all about having the right mindset, as it is with all of the topics in this book. It always comes back to your approach. Mindset is the set of instructions you use to carry out an objective or achieve a goal. It's about learning how to be more effective in less time, so

that you have more time to do the things you love—the things that make you happy—the things that make you feel not just good, but great.

Only you have the power to make these changes, but I promise you, it's not hard. It will take some practice and it may be challenging at times, but it is not difficult, and it is so well worth it. And I will be there with you every step of the way. We're not recreating the wheel here. We're essentially retraining our minds to help us go from good to great.

To help us make that transition, I've developed a blueprint for success. With it, you can pivot from a mindset of struggling to a mindset of triumph and success. That blueprint is made up of four simple steps that we will talk about throughout this book—renovate, innovate, collaborate, repeat. And the best part? This can be done by anyone, at any time, in any phase of their life.

With the right mindset, you will become more connected to your community, to your relationships, and most importantly, to yourself.

This book is for …

- Those who feel a need, deep down inside, to build their knowledge about the power of mindset in personal and professional growth.

- Those who are ready to level-up their minds, careers, and relationships to reach the highest version of themselves.

- Those who understand that everything we do starts with our attitude and intention.

- Those who believe it's time to become more in order to have more.

Aren't you ready to start taking control of your life?

Chapter 1

Mindset

The Key to Unlocking Your Life

We all have a certain mindset, of course, but did you ever stop to think about what that really is? Mindset is a set of beliefs and assumptions that shape how you make sense of the world and yourself in it. It will influence how you think, feel, and act in any given situation. You will then set expectations or intentions from that place. School may have taught us certain things, but it could never truly teach us what we need to operate on a higher level—that's all in our own mindsets.

There are two main types of mindsets—fixed and growth. Those with fixed mindsets believe that their lives, and everything in them, are unchangeable. Basically, they are just there for the ride and will react as needed. They won't take risks for fear of failure, and they shy away from challenges.

On the other hand, people with a growth mindset understand that nothing is static and that instead, they will grow and change over time. They are more open to exploring opportunities and putting themselves out there in an effort to improve the quality of their lives. They

don't take failures personally but as unique opportunities to learn and grow. They see weakness as something to overcome, rather than something to which to succumb.

I'm hoping you can tell by those descriptions that fixed mindsets make it nearly impossible to achieve personal growth or improve the quality of your life. Those with a fixed mindset are not willing to accept change. And change and transformation is exactly what we need right now. A growth mindset is required for this development. Simply, a growth mindset is needed to go from good to great.

Some will confuse a growth mindset with positivity. A growth mindset is far more than just positive thinking though. Instead, it's about shifting perception. The journey of developing a growth mindset can be a deeply personal one, especially when someone had a fixed mindset for so long. It's important to remember that everyone is coming from a different place in terms of their growth mindset and self-esteem journey.

As for me, my conscious awareness of growth mindset occurred at a very young age (although I definitely didn't know the term then). My dad passed away when I was barely two years old, and my mom eventually remarried and had twins when I was around the age of seven. I felt a difference—a subtle shift in the way things were and the way we lived. But not only did I feel it, I started questioning *what made me feel it*. Basically, I started questioning life at an extremely young age.

I would ask myself questions like –

- *What makes things feel different?*

- *Why is that so?*
- *Is it external (them) or internal (me)?*
- *Is it a combination?*

But I moved on. After all, not nearly enough adults understand these types of questions, let alone a young child. I went to school and always did great, but school was never much of a challenge to me. The biggest challenges came from changes of scenery as I would consistently find myself in a new place, but with a familiar feeling. I went to seven different schools within nine years. The constant change of scenery challenged me to overcome the obstacles and objections that came my way year after year.

Then, when I was in 9th grade, my mom passed away after a battle with cancer. I was lost, realizing I no longer had parents. I became very depressed, and I then spent time living with both grandparents. I also found basketball around the same time. I put all of my energy into playing the game and improving. Soon, I noticed that I also felt a lot better. Once again, I started to realize the impact of mindset. I started to feel that with the right mindset, I could push myself through anything that was thrown my way.

I graduated and went to college, and my entrepreneurial spirit was itching to be released even then. I created a delivery snack vending machine business selling candy and snacks to classmates between classes. When I graduated from college, I did what I "was supposed to do." I got a job and then another one. I was a sales specialist, sports and team education coach, graphic designer, and consultant, on top of being a media

production entrepreneur. But that's what we do. We work hard in high school, graduate, work hard in college, graduate, get a good job, and work hard more. That's what we're *supposed* to do. That's a *good* life.

So, I worked hard, and I actually did like it, to an extent. Ironically, it seemed like an extension of school to me—just replace classes with meetings, keep the same lunch break, then more meetings, and then we go home at the end of the day. My restlessness grew, especially as I would see the work I spent hours on be attributed to my company without any mention of me or my graphics team. Even though I was getting paid, there was that voice once again questioning if this was really what my life was supposed to be.

Not long after, I had gotten sick with chronic GERD, Gastro Esophageal Reflux Disease. I could no longer go into the office. But I realized during that time that I could also do the exact same work from home. When it was time to go back into the office, I asked my employer if I could work from home instead. They would not allow it, and I immediately knew my answer.

That restlessness had made its way to the surface. My mindset shifted. Suddenly, I was asking, "Why not do the same work for myself?" I quit my job and never looked back. And now, I have helped build a huge platform that not only generates revenue, but gives me the satisfaction of making my own way and, most importantly, helping others as I go. By letting go of what no longer served me, I made more time and space to learn, educate, and grow with a community of new and experienced entrepreneurs who are changing the world as we speak.

Through every twist and turn in my personal and professional paths, it was my mindset that navigated the way. Make no mistake, mindset is one of the most powerful tools we have. Before I even knew what the term meant—it guided me, just as it is doing for you right now.

Developing Your Mindset

If you're reading this and thinking you probably have a fixed mindset, please do not get discouraged. As with most things in life, if you put the work in and have the attitude of gratitude, anything is possible—and that includes developing a growth mindset. With some conscious decisions, work, and practice, we can make the changes we need. The key to transforming a fixed mindset is to continue to tell yourself that your skills, abilities, and talents are not predetermined and that you are able to make changes over time.

One of the best ways to do this is to be aware of the negative self-talk we're all guilty of from time to time. Catch yourself and change the narrative. For example, "I'm a failure" turns into "I know I'll do better next time." You'll be amazed at how much influence this self-talk has on your mindset.

Another way is to exit your comfort zone and take risks. Soon, you'll be able to see that not only will you survive a "failure" or let down, but you will often thrive once you get to the other side. You'll start to see that you are learning and, by extension, growing into the person you want to be. These shifts may take some work to start, but

they will become more natural until they are embedded into your subconscious.

When you tap into yourself, you'll find that all of the answers you've been searching for can be found within. When you master your mind, you elevate your life, and simplify your success.

Time for Action

- Identify if you have a fixed or growth mindset and why.
- Transform negative self-talk into positive affirmations.
- Try something you've always wanted to do.
- Let go of something that no longer serves you.
- Incorporate the word "yet" when you're telling yourself something ("I'm not good at this yet").
- Use more positive vocabulary in your narratives.

Time for Reflection

- *Do you have a growth mindset? If yes, how. If no, what can you do about it?*
- *What are 5-10 instances of regular negative self-talk? How can you revise them?*
- *What is something you've always wanted to do? What has held you back? How can you change that?*

Chapter 2

Confidence

The Power of Believing in Yourself

A key factor, and probably the one you need the most, in having a powerful mindset is confidence. Confidence is the quality or state of being certain—a state of trust in yourself and others. Trusting yourself doesn't come easy for most people, but if it's practiced daily, it can be developed, just like mindset.

Confident people act in certain ways. Among others, they will:

- Admit when they are wrong.
- Refrain from critical judgment when discussing personal success (and usually mention others who helped along the way).
- Take criticism, but remain certain of their worth.
- Accept a compliment, without limiting language.
- Have the attitude of gratitude.
- Spread love and joy.
- Operate honestly.
- Believe they are the casting director, producer, and star of their own movie.

Some people confuse confidence with conceit, but they are two very different traits. While a confident person has a strong self-belief in their abilities, a conceited person has an excessively favorable opinion of themselves. A confident person will accept their flaws as ways to improve, while a conceited person will not acknowledge any flaws in the first place.

Confidence is a skill, and just like any other skill, it can be improved upon and nurtured through your habits. A confident person will speak with conviction, but also actively listen to others. They aren't afraid to ask for advice or help and will take advantage of opportunities, just as much as they will take responsibility for their own actions. They will step outside of their comfort zones, and won't shy away from conflict or procrastinate.

Self-Belief

At its foundation, confidence is about self-belief—a person's belief in their ability to complete tasks and to achieve their goals. If you believe you are capable of success, the thought alone actually increases your chances to succeed. And the opposite holds true. If you don't believe you deserve it or have the knowledge to achieve it, you won't.

Often, our self-belief is diminished by our interpretation of what's going on in our environment. That's why it's important to surround yourself with beautiful energy, where you are supported and encouraged. But something to remember is that self-belief is actualized only through

you—no one else. Ultimately, your success depends only on your belief and your actions.

If you feel as if you are lacking in this area, that's okay—for now. We're going to work on it! And I promise you that at one point in your lifetime, you likely had self-belief. But in troubled times, you may have lost sight of it. You can always choose to rediscover what you're all about and ignite that self-belief all over again by being intentional.

Intentionality

Being intentional is about small, conscious daily decisions concerning what enhances your life or brings you joy in some way. It encourages defining your priorities to help you reach your goals, whether they are personal or professional. Every decision you make begins with the intention to do so.

Let's start with something simple—being intentional about your day. You can structure your day by writing down your plans and carefully defining your goals. Don't just set them to cross something off a list somewhere. Again, you are practicing intentionality, so everything you do should be with clear purpose. Think about what you want and what will help you progress further along your path. Then, set goals that will help you get there.

Being intentional also means creating healthy habits to provide a fuller, happier life, including knowing that your time is valuable by investing it wisely (we are going to talk a lot more about habits in Chapter 7). And remembering that finding time to relax is just as

important as finding time to work. We must always strive toward creating a workable balance, which is essential to avoiding burnout. As always, practicing gratitude is key—reflect on what you are grateful for and what adds value to your life. Keep this in mind when setting your priorities and goals.

When you have intentionally set those goals and have the self-belief and confidence that you will reach them, it is time for action. And a person's actions are based on individual beliefs. Some might confuse action with reaction, but they are not entirely the same. Intentional action with fortitude and conviction is very different than merely reacting to various stimuli.

Intentionality is a practice, trust is a practice, and confidence is a practice. But with enough of it, you will make progress in a way that will ultimately lead you to alignment. And when you are in alignment with your intention and future possibilities, the results are endlessly abundant.

Time for Action

To build confidence:

- Practice gratitude.
- Remind yourself of your victories.
- Search for wins daily.
- Think about what you learned after “failures.”
- Never judge others.
- Step outside of your comfort zone.
- Have the “I can handle it” mindset.
- Seek only internal validation.
- Exercise and eat healthy.

To act with intention:

- Be smart with your money. Being more intentional with your money will allow for you to spend more on what you need and what makes you happy.

- Keep your home clean. Show respect to yourself and your space. You deserve it!

- Be aware of your mental health. No good ever comes from ignoring the way you feel. Pay attention. When your body is calling for help, you should answer.

- Practice self-care and self-reflection. Take some time every day to check in with yourself. Reflect

on your successes and “failures” for the day, and think of how to improve.

- Plan, prepare, and get organized—with everything. Proper planning and preparation are essential to reaching your goals in a consistent manner.

Time for Reflection

- *In what ways are you confident? In what ways are you not confident?*
- *In what ways can you begin self-care?*
- *What is one area you will commit to getting organized in your home? In your office?*

Chapter 3

Alignment

The Power of Harmony

When you think of the word "alignment," you may think of a chiropractor's office. I get it—that's where we often hear the term. But we're not talking about a chiropractor or a back adjustment here. We're talking about when your thoughts, feelings, behaviors, and actions are aligned in a way that brings a certain harmony to your life. Alignment is the proper positioning or state of adjustment of parts in relation to each other—in this context—intention, thoughts, and action.

Aligning Intention with Thoughts

As we discussed in Chapter 2, intention is extremely powerful. When you start with gratitude, identify your core values, and declare your intention, you are creating your own unique plan for personal development and reaching goals.

Your thoughts should always be aligned with what is truly important to you. Unfortunately, most of the thoughts in our heads are not useful and actually hinder our development. Be aware of them, intercept them, and

dismiss them as soon as possible to give your mind space to focus on the thoughts that are productive.

Asking yourself these questions can help:

- What thoughts and intentions do I need to achieve my goals? Do I consistently think these thoughts?
- Which of my thoughts are counterproductive to my true purpose?
- What is the source of these thoughts?
- What is a replacement thought I could have instead?

As you answer these questions, you must resist the urge to scold yourself for having counterproductive thoughts. This takes time, and no matter how much we perfect the process, we will still have them from time to time—we are human! The idea is not to try to eliminate them completely, but to reduce them so that a vast majority of thoughts are productive in nature instead.

Aligning intention with thoughts doesn't happen overnight. Thinking productively is a skill that must be developed and exercised over time. Be patient with yourself and work on it each day. You will get there.

Aligning Intention with Action

Setting an intention is the first step in manifesting what you want. But that's not enough. We don't want to live with our head in the clouds, just dreaming away. We need action too. And far too often, our actions, like our thoughts, are counterproductive to the intentions we set.

Simply, achieving goals can only occur when those actions are aligned with our intentions.

Overall, there are two types of actions—anticipatory or reactionary. With anticipatory, actions are taken with a specific intention to help bring about a future event. These actions are taken with the understanding that failure is an option, and that's okay. Essentially, you are dictating the action you take based on your choice, or your intent.

On the other hand, reactionary actions are those taken in response to an event that has already occurred. Sometimes, these are necessary—we have to react to certain stimuli in order to move forward. However, we can't be in reactionary mode our entire lives just waiting to response to events after they happen. We must set intentions and anticipate what we want as much as possible.

Regardless of whether you are acting from an anticipatory or reactionary perspective, make sure to reconnect with your intention by considering what achieving those goals will feel like with each step. Think about it over and over again and allow yourself to imagine what that success will feel like. Enjoy it for a moment. Then, get back to taking action. This practice will help maintain alignment in all that you do.

Authentic Alignment

By its very nature, alignment must be authentic. Authenticity is the quality of being genuine and true to your own personality—who you are at your core. Your

thoughts, visions, values, and intentions are all a part of you. Through them, you are the reflection of who you want to be.

It all starts in our own minds and how we see the things and people around us, as well as where we fit into the whole. If you want freedom and clarity of thought, be authentic with yourself and with others. Don't ever deny who you are or where you want to go. Own your strengths and your weaknesses and work your plan for improvements where you need them.

We've all heard the saying, "Be the change you want to see in the world"—well, it's not cliché, it's the truth. And that transformation can only occur with alignment, where we can create the space we need to be more effective in less time with our choices.

Time for Action

- Reflect on your beliefs, principles, and assumptions about life. Then, challenge them all.
- Develop an awareness of spontaneous thoughts.
- Choose a recent situation and reevaluate it from a different perspective.
- Identify counterproductive thoughts and replace them with productive ones.
- Intercept any all-or-nothing thinking.
- Journal your thoughts and actions. Are they aligned?
- Read a spiritual book.

Time for Reflection

- *Who are you?*
- *Who do you want to be?*
- *Who did you think you would become?*
- *Are these aligned? If not, what is preventing them from being aligned?*
- *What habits are most closely aligned to who you are and who you want to be? Which ones are the furthest?*

Chapter 4

Becoming More Effective in Less Time

When it's Time to Transform

When you're truly ready to transform your life—to make sure you have the right mindset to take your life from good to great—you'll learn to become more effective in less time. In that moment, it becomes more than something you just want. It becomes something you need deep down in your core. You are ready to go from good to great, from dependency to interdependency by creating mutually beneficial relationships in all that you do. As you make this transformation, you realize that all of your goals are always bigger than you individually.

I told you briefly about my own story in Chapter 1—about how I started to compare being paid at a job doing work for someone else to being paid to lead a company and do work for myself. This is one example of how I chose to be more effective in less time.

From my perspective, it was simply not effective to work to bring someone else more money and more credit when I could do the same thing for myself. Now, this is not to say that in order to be more effective in less time,

everyone has to quit their job and become an entrepreneur. This is just one example based on my own circumstances. Remember what I said in the beginning of the book—this is all about *you*. Just because something works for one person does not mean that is the answer for everyone else. The key, regardless of the situation, is to change your perspective and think about what makes sense for you.

It's in Your Approach

I used to think that maybe I did things in a harder way compared to other ways that could be much easier. I wondered if I could be doing something and thinking it's working, but in fact, there was an easier and more effective way to do the same thing. The more I thought about it, the more my mind discovered that my approach to many things was a lot harder than it needed to be. Then I thought that most people probably also go through life making choices and approaching situations in a more challenging manner when there could be an easier way.

I think we've conditioned ourselves to take the harder route in life. That's because most people think the harder route is more honorable than the easier one. We've been heavily conditioned to make harder choices in life and to always work hard, so much so that we don't even realize we are making a harder choice or approaching a situation in a more difficult manner than required.

What if what we know as the harder approach is actually the easier approach and what we think is the easier approach is actually the harder one? What if things being

easier lead directly to us becoming more effective in less time? What if being more effective in less time means we can earn more money, enjoy more of our time, and positively impact others?

What I've come to learn is that easier doesn't mean less honorable. Easier could mean less resistance, more flow, and more abundance. For example, have you ever had a predetermined thought for what the outcome of a given situation would be? Have you ever been reluctant to go somewhere, but you did, and then you didn't want to leave by the end of it? So, instead of creating a predetermined outcome of a situation, there would be more flow, abundance, and happiness if you set an intention and then see where the flow takes you within the alignment of that intention.

What if I told you the key to being more effective in less time is as simple as finding an easier and more effective approach than your current approach for achieving your goals? The truth of the matter – it is.

As you master becoming more effective with your time, you will start to see that you have more room in your life to fully engage, experience, and enjoy it. This is when beautiful things start to happen seemingly out of nowhere. But you will know better—they are not out of nowhere at all. They are happening because you have created the space for them to appear. You pushed aside the chaos life can often bring and chose to set space apart for peace and fulfillment, so the things that bring you those will begin to appear. And now they are.

So, how do you become more effective in less time? Start by asking yourself some questions in self-reflection:

- *What are my intentions?*
- *What sort of impact would I like to make?*
- *Where is my time being spent?*
- *How can I be more efficient with my time?*
- *What would come into my life if I had more time?*

As always, we start with intention. To manifest your intention, you must not only commit to it, but consistently work toward it with your actions. There is really no difference from what we talked about in earlier chapters. The key point here is being aware of the efficiency of those thoughts and actions, so that you can free up time and space to make room for what you truly want.

In seeking to improve efficiency in our lives, it's important to remember that everything we do is based on energy and that all energy is repurposed and reproduced. Energy comes from within and surrounds us. We must create a system to help get the very best energy out of our environments, including those in it.

Remember, we exist in balance with our surroundings. By creating mutually beneficial relationships to uphold the best interests of ourselves and those around us, it encourages everyone involved to operate from their highest potential. And when we operate from our highest potential, we see the most significant impacts in efficiency, as well as in the quality of our lives.

The Renovate, Innovate, and Collaborate Method

Getting more effective in less time does not mean starting from scratch. Rather, it's most effective (pun intended) to use what is already at our disposal. I like to call it the renovate, innovate, and collaborate method. This formula allows us to easily know what our next move should be. I encourage you to use this to measure your growth and to create the blueprint for the next move in your career, business, or relationship.

As you may have guessed, there are three essential steps to this method –

1. Renovate. Take something that already exists and add value to it. Fix it up or make it into something new.

2. Innovate. After you add value, add your own specific twist, spin, or signature to it.

3. Collaborate. Work with others who are already in alignment with what you want to accomplish.

Let me put these steps into context. Let's take the concept of public speaking. It's been around a long time, right? I definitely didn't invent it or create it, but I did renovate it. I took what I had learned, packaged it in a different way, and incorporated it into what works for those in my current environment. Next, I put my own signature on it by creating a community for millennials and entrepreneurs called Luhv+—a place where creatives, entrepreneurs, and young business professionals can gather to master their minds, elevate

their lives, and simplify success. This is where my messages would be most needed and appreciated.

Then, I moved on to the collaboration step. I was able to take this action and connect entrepreneurs to themselves and to others by inviting them to creatively visualize what they want to show up in their worlds. This collaboration helped them put an end to procrastination by holding them accountable *to hold themselves accountable* to operate from their highest potential.

Think about Uber—they've used this formula, as well. They renovated the "call up" taxicab service by creating an app for the service. They innovated the process by putting their own twist and signature on it and then they collaborated with new and existing drivers, car service users, and other companies like American Express. Once Uber hit the scene, competitors started to emerge. For instance, Lyft renovated, innovated, and collaborated on Uber's approach of transforming the car service business. This process is everywhere around us.

The Impact of Perspective

As you engage in the Renovate, Innovate, and Collaborate Method, it's crucial to remember that we all have unique perspectives of life. The way something appears to one can appear completely different to someone else. Think about it—two entirely different realities based on the same stimuli.

Each person believes something is right if it makes sense to them. We should have conversations with the understanding that the person is operating from their

own circumstances and experience, which creates their own perspective. Arguing with someone is forcing them to see your view. Simply put, there's really no need to argue. The other person's view is part of our journey too, and we need their perspective for one reason or another. Their perspectives are 100% valid. And even if only to them, they matter.

For example, think about the word "challenge" for a moment. If you're like some, you may initially think about problems, issues, difficulties, or struggles. For many, there is a negative connotation, but with a growth mindset, there is nothing negative about it. To those with a growth mindset, the word "challenge" is actually positive. In fact, we all love a good challenge—even with ourselves. We like to push ourselves and learn. We want to do better. We strive to meet goals. And they are *all* challenges. But once again, it comes down to the perspective to appreciate them for what they really are.

As another example, we offer various challenges on our platform, and our Luhv+ Productivity Challenge and our Business Execution Challenge are by far the most popular ones. *Why?* Because it is human nature to want to do our best and to be productive—to be more efficient—to save time—to get things done. We want to take the action we need to move forward and step into our greatness. We want to be doers by being more effective in less time!

Time for Action

- Journal about one activity in your life that you would like to work with.

- Ask yourself how you can add value to that activity. Describe it in your journal.

- Ask yourself how you can add your spin to it. Describe it in your journal.

- List who you know and who you would like to meet who are in alignment with the end result you hope to achieve.

- Develop a plan on how to bring these people into your life.

Time for Reflection

- *What is something in your life that brings you joy?*
- *How can you improve it even more?*
- *Who can help you on this journey? What is your plan to connect with them?*

Chapter 5

Law of Love

The Power of Self-Love

Love, as they say, makes the world go round. And it is a big part of most of our lives. We want to feel it and provide it to others whom we care about. There is nothing quite like being in love. But did you know that love is actually a vibration? It is pure energy and a source of success because with love, everything really is possible. Simply, love has the power to shift the world … but it must begin with us.

When we think about love, we often think about our loved ones. Sometimes, we think of things we love to do. But rarely do we think about self-love. To move forward with a growth mindset, we must understand what self-love means. But let me stop you before you even think it—it has nothing to do with being conceited or full of yourself.

Loving Yourself First

Self-love is often described as a state of appreciation for oneself. It means that you value your own well-being and happiness, and that you take care of your own needs. It

also means that you will not sacrifice those needs to please others.

Isn't that exactly what we've been talking about?

Isn't it all a part of a healthy mindset?

Just like with confidence and intention, developing self-love will take practice. Actually, by taking the actions we discussed to develop confidence and intention setting, you will automatically increase your self-love. Talk about being more effective in less time!

Self-love means accepting yourself fully (both your strengths and weaknesses), understanding that there is no perfection in this lifetime, and discovering what is most important to you. It is setting boundaries, protecting yourself, and forgiving yourself. It is living intentionally.

Self-love is in no way selfish, as some may mistakenly believe. It's anything but. In fact, without self-love, you cannot love others fully. Let me explain. I used to be pretty consumed with myself—I admit it. I think most of us are when we are younger. It's like we are the only thing that matters in the universe. Just us. We need nothing else. Well, that's our ego talking.

Everyone has an ego, and it always tells us that we are the only thing that's important. When we are acting from this state, we're all that matters, but not in a confident, positive, self-loving way. We're more concerned with other people's thoughts about us than about our own thoughts and feelings. In fact, we are consumed with

other people's perspectives, rather than understanding our own. We seek the approval of others instead of ourselves.

As I shifted my mindset, I started thinking more about the experiences I had, including the reactions I would have toward others, and the negativity surrounding it all too often. I started to think a lot about perspectives and how one can be extraordinarily different from another, even in the exact same situation.

What I came to discover is that it is not just about me. I am connected to those around me and to others I haven't even discovered yet. I am connected to my surroundings and the energy in it. And so is everyone else. All of that interdependency affects how I treat my experiences and how I treat others. This was another substantial shift in my life.

I made a change there and then. I realized if I got mad at someone, I was choosing to be in that emotional state. In that situation, I should have asked myself, would I be mad if this person was not here? If the answer was no (and it often was), then I had created a negative space for myself by blaming someone else for my attitude. And I was the only one responsible for my actions, thoughts, and feelings.

Now, whenever I am annoyed or hurt by others, I find a place where I can love them more. I discover ways to support them in their worlds. To see things from their perspective. This has made me more knowledgeable about compassion and empathy, and a kinder individual

overall. I am totally engaged with, and happy for, others and their accomplishments.

But I could only make this transformation and connect with others by loving myself first.

Time for Action

- Journal
    - What can you do to change how you feel?
    - Is there someone you are angry with? Why?
    - What could the situation look like from their perspective?

Time for Reflection

- *What are your favorite qualities about yourself?*
- *What are qualities you don't particularly like? Why is that?*

Chapter 6

Law of Connectivity

The Power of Human Connection

The law of connectivity says that the more we connect within ourselves, the more we will connect to others. The more we act with love and kindness, the more our world will be filled with love and kindness. There is a direct reflection in our relationship with the world around us—what we put out into it is what we get back … always.

This connectivity is, in part, about interdependency—the combination of our own effort to achieve a goal with the assistance and effort of others. The universe is one colossal collective consciousness, and interdependency is a fundamental law of nature. Every element is dependent on its own condition, and with the collaboration of others, it creates additional elements. These elements contain energy that cannot be destroyed.

Connecting with Others from the Start

The law of connectivity when first meeting someone includes:

1. Disarming them. Peacefully greet them and state your intentions clearly. People are naturally

defensive or scared, but you can make them more relaxed.

2. Acknowledging them. People want to be heard. Show them that you are listening with eye contact and active listening skills. Point out something they said that interests you.
3. Discovering them. Inquire about something you want to know. People may be apprehensive, but if you ask them a question and listen to what they are expressing, what they truly want usually shows itself without them even noticing.
4. Appreciating them. Show them that what has been shared matters and identify hidden problems. People would appreciate it if you could help them simplify their life, mind, thoughts, or words. And you would feel better helping. If you have a question, suggestion, or insight that could be valuable to that person, ask "May I give a consideration?" Then, state what you have to say, if they are open to hearing it.

In many instances, just listening (and not thinking) is exactly what we need to connect to others or even to ourselves. Oftentimes, it's listening to the silence. That's where many of our answers can be found because they are all already inside us. It takes us quieting our mind and all the chatter around us to really hear them though. Nothing happens without listening first.

Here are some helpful reminders about how to connect better to your surroundings, others, and yourself –

- Follow through on your word. If you need help, get a calendar and use it to schedule

appointments, meetings, and even personal phone calls. Stick to your word always, whether to a friend, a partner, or to yourself. Scheduling sets the foundation of integrity and connectivity.

- Remember to support and listen to others without bias.
- Don't tell people what to do. Simply ask them what they think.
- Understand that everyone has their own perspective and embrace it, even if you don't agree.
- Never try to force anyone else to agree with your perspective.
- Be in service of others. Servitude can be in the form of doing, listening, or being. And combining all three creates powerful and magical connections. Serve others without having an agenda, other than creating a space for that person to feel loved, heard, valued, respected, and ultimately like they matter. When you're in service of others, you will find that you're also in service of yourself.
- Think about what possibilities you could offer to others with whom you come in contact.

Connecting to the Moment You're In

As we connect with ourselves and others, we should remember to connect with time. Connect to the moment you're in by living as this could be the last day you'll ever see. This is not being morbid. This is how we should live each day. Let people know how important they are to your life and to your goals. Not later or when it is more

convenient, but now. This creates a profound perspective that few other interactions can compare to.

Living in the moment doesn't just mean appreciating the moment, it also means acting in the moment. And, as always, having gratitude is paramount. I am continuously consciously thankful for my existence and having an opportunity to impact those around me. It is simply the greatest gift I have ever received.

Our environment reflects our attitude. And our attitude reflects our environment. Everything in this life, and in us, is eternally connected.

Time for Action

- Practice engaging with others in thoughtful ways by using the steps listed in the chapter.

- Take two minutes each day to focus on breathing and the time in which you find yourself.

- Show gratitude for all that you do in meaningful ways.

Time for Reflection

- *How active are your listening skills? How can you improve them?*
- *List 3-5 individuals or organizations to which you could be of service. How?*

Chapter 7

Getting Stuck
And Getting Unstuck

We're human. And as imperfect humans, we must remember that there is absolutely no perfection in this extraordinary life we are blessed to live. When we strive to make it "perfect" and realize we can't though, we tend to think we've failed. But honestly, there is no failure—only opportunities to learn and grow. It is the same exact situation, but as always, it is how you choose to look at it—it's your perspective that matters most.

When we feel like this, we tend to get, as some may call it, "stuck." We aren't making forward progression, and we aren't growing or learning anything (the only way to make progress). We could be stuck with confidence, self-belief, growth, energy, communication, or any number of other things. But irrespective of the "what," the "why" is often rooted in the fact that we are trying to be something we're not or trying to force a path we think is ours, but truly isn't.

A Note on Procrastination

There is no doubt that we all have some common tendencies we fall into when we feel stuck. And one of the biggest traps is procrastination. The word procrastination comes from the Latin verb *procrastinare*, meaning "to put off until tomorrow."

We know procrastination is irrational and yet, we do it anyway. The vicious cycle is initiated due to an inability to manage the negative attitudes we have about a particular task or because it's a physical manifestation of our feelings of being stuck. We feel stuck, so we make ourselves stuck by not doing what we need to do.

When we procrastinate, believe it or not, it has nothing to do with self-control. And going back to mindset, it's really about unlearning the misconceptions planted in our heads (from ourselves or from others). We'll think we are just lazy, or we have a time management problem. But procrastination is nothing more than an emotion regulation problem.

We use procrastination as a means of "short-term mood repair." However, this does nothing to rid us of those feelings leading to increased stress and anxiety and feelings of low self-esteem or self-blame. And now, we are even more stressed because we are behind on what we needed to accomplish.

Practicing self-compassion is one of the best ways of decreasing procrastination and increasing productivity. It can also help lower stress and increase motivation and feelings of self-worth.

Other tips to help beat procrastination:

- Focus on a single task you've been putting off. Do not think about everything at once, which will only make you further overwhelmed and procrastinate even more.
- Remember FOCUS stands for Fulfilling Obligations Consistently Until Successful. Focusing on a task becomes easier when there aren't other distractions around.
- Minimize multitasking and disconnect from distractions.
- Ask yourself what you can get done in five minutes that will allow you to move forward. Then set a timer. But once you start it, you're more likely to keep going anyway (a little trick there!).
- Designate "Power Hours," where you work without distraction for an hour, then take a short break.
- Be kind to yourself.

Other Unhealthy "Stuck" Habits

We will often engage in other unhealthy habits when we are feeling stuck. Those habits are generally found in what we eat, how we sleep, and how we take care of our bodies and minds—all crucial components to mindset.

Eating healthy, getting enough sleep, and moving your body are habits that can positively affect your health and overall life, but they take work. And when we are feeling stuck, the last thing we want to do is work. We'd rather

hide in the shadows until life gets easier. But the thing is—life will *never* get easier. It is up to us to take action, have a growth mindset, and make the changes within ourselves, so that it no longer seems so difficult. That's perspective, and that's the key.

When it comes to eating healthier, it's important to do it for the reasons that will keep you dedicated and motivated. It's not about being a certain size or how you look in photos. Rather, it's about focusing on eating nutritious foods to provide your body with the fuel it needs to keep all systems running smoothly so you can operate at your highest potential. Not receiving proper nutrition can lead to decreased focus and higher stress and irritability—the exact opposite of what we're trying to accomplish.

Sleep also has a huge impact on our mental and emotional health, including productivity and mental sharpness. Ninety percent of new entrepreneurs suffer from lack of adequate restful sleep. In making sleep a priority, you may want to consider the following:

- Try to get eight hours of sleep each night.
- Avoid caffeine after 2:00 pm.
- Avoid eating after 8:00 pm.
- Make sure your room is quiet, dark, and free of clutter.
- Have a consistent, peaceful bedtime routine or meditate before going to bed.

We also can't talk about ways to get unstuck without talking about exercise. Keeping your body healthy will

help to keep your mind healthy. It's important to find a fitness habit that works for you and then incorporate it into your daily routine. Regardless of how busy you are, you can make the decision to live healthier—even if that means starting with a fifteen minute walk every morning. Whatever it is, make sure you enjoy it, so you are more likely to continue.

Transforming Habits

Everything we are talking about to get ourselves unstuck is fundamentally about habits. We are creators of life, but we are also creatures of habit. And our quality of life is found embedded in those habits. These are the things that we do every day. And remember, the way you do one thing in life is the way you do everything in life.

Imagine a world where others consistently work together to create a prosperous, healthy, harmonious life of abundance. Now, ask yourself—If your habits projected your quality of life, what would that look like? What would it feel like?

When you go about engaging in a habit, ask yourself if what you are doing is going to enhance your life in some way. If it is, then keep doing it. If it's not, then it's time to make a change.

Changing a habit takes some work, but with consistency, it can usually be done within a couple of months (depending on what it is). To change a habit:

- Choose a healthier substitute for it.
- Learn your triggers and avoid them whenever you can.

- Enlist the help of your loved ones for support.
- Surround yourself with people who live the way you want to live and have better habits.
- Use the word “but” to overcome negative self-talk.
- If you slip up, recognize that it’s okay, as long as you pick yourself back up and try again.

Mind Over Matter

Once again, it comes down to your mindset and prioritizing what is most important to you. With practice and consistency, you can develop new habits that will help you get out of your own way and create the life you want. It is there waiting for you to discover it.

You must allow yourself the time and space to grow and to have patience with the process. None of this happens overnight. It takes time, focus, determination, smart work, and new habits.

When you’re feeling stuck, don’t be hard on yourself. We are all there at certain points in our lives, and that’s okay. Accept your situation, identify the cause of being stuck, and then start with small, manageable changes. Remember to think about your goals and where you want to go, but also that none of your journey will be perfect because, simply, no journey is perfect. Most importantly, remember to take care of yourself always.

Time for Action

- Identify the triggers that cause you to engage in unhealthy habits.
- Identify healthier substitutes for those habits.
- Focus on one habit to change at a time.
- Practice the new habit consistently for 30-60 days.

Time for Reflection

- *What is your purpose?*
- *What is your why?*
- *What are your current habits? What is one you can work on changing now?*

Chapter 8

Forgiveness

The Power of Forgiving Ourselves & Others

This transformation we've been talking about cannot happen if we hold onto anything that doesn't serve us, including anger, disappointment, grudges, or any other form of negativity. We must consciously practice letting this go because it is the only way to allow more positive energy to flow into us.

We tend to hold onto who we were in the past—we all do from time to time. Most of us can't become who we need to be because we are too busy holding onto who we "are." We hold onto hurt and anger and then operate from that negative space. This only keeps us stagnant, trapped in our own destructive mindset. We're not going to do that anymore! And to make this change, we must talk about the power of forgiveness.

When we hold onto a grudge, we feel more anger and bitterness in relationships and personal experiences. We can't enjoy the present because we are constantly living in the past. This can easily lead to anxiety and depression, which are, of course, serious mental health issues. Simply, the inability to forgive and move on impacts

everything in our lives in an extraordinarily detrimental way.

When we talk about forgiveness, remember we are talking about forgiving others and ourselves (and oftentimes, that's even harder). Forgiveness is about letting go of grudges and bitterness to find peace and to truly be able to move forward, unrestrained by the past. It is not about forgetting or excusing the harm done, as so many believe.

So, you may be asking, "How do I reach a state of forgiveness?" I think the best way to start is to recognize the value of forgiveness. Then, identify exactly what needs healing and who needs to be forgiven for what. Acknowledge your emotions around the harm that has been done. And finally, make a conscious decision with *intention* to forgive the other person, as well as yourself.

When we learn to forgive, we are the ones who benefit most, both mentally and physically. It's not about the other person or "letting them off the hook." It's truly about us. Here are a few of the many benefits shown from forgiveness:

- Improved mental health
- Less anxiety, stress, and hostility
- Lower blood pressure
- Fewer symptoms of depression
- Healthier relationships
- A stronger immune system
- Improved heart health
- Improved self-esteem

Forgiving Yourself

As I mentioned earlier, forgiving yourself is often more difficult than forgiving others. That's because we tend to be hardest on ourselves. We know better! We could do better! We're disappointed in ourselves.

To do so, we must focus on our emotions and learn to acknowledge and process them. Acknowledge the mistake out loud and more importantly, what we've learned from that mistake. Voicing the thoughts in our heads help us imprint on our minds what we've learned. Soon, we begin to consider each mistake as a learning experience (there's that shift again).

This is a huge part of learning to forgive yourself—not viewing mistakes as setbacks, but rather as learning experiences. Give yourself permission to put the process on hold, with gratitude. If a mistake is giving you a particularly hard time, put it in a mental box and return to it when it will benefit you most.

You can also have a conversation with your inner critic. Notice when you are being self-critical. Quiet the negative messages of your inner critic by getting clear about what you truly want. Show yourself the kindness and compassion you would show others in the same situation. The difference is incredible.

You're probably seeing the common thread by now—it all starts from within. With a positive mindset, you can let go of the need for vengeance and choose to forgive

and move on. Remember forgiveness is far more powerful than revenge.

Time for Action

- Practice forgiveness by choosing to forgive someone. If possible, take 10-15 minutes to call or talk to that person face to face.

- Create a journal entry about who you need to forgive and why.

- Identify something for which you need to forgive yourself.

Time for Reflection

- *Who do you need to forgive? Why?*
- *What is something for which you can forgive yourself?*

Chapter 9

Realignment

Meditation, Affirmations, & Inspiration

We talk a lot about our own energy when we talk about having a growth mindset. And there are many ways you can tap into your energy to help you get the results you want. Once again, this will involve patience, practice, and developing new habits. Through these actions, you can practice living on the level you choose by creating the habits that will take you there.

On my own journey, I started to become aware that what was showing up in my life was a direct reflection of the energy I was putting out there—the energy that resulted from my thoughts and intentions. It followed then that if I continuously practiced the habits that my higher self would practice, I could continuously improve and evolve my life.

Focus is essential to this process because it brings forth intuitive development and growth. If you spend twenty-five minutes straight focusing on something new, you will expand your mind and knowledge. And this practice will bring forth a greater quality of life. If you could do two twenty-five-minute sessions, with a five-minute

break in between, you will see changes even faster. When I started this, my productivity expanded exponentially.

To tap into your own energy, try these steps:

- Set your intention.
- Feed you mind with a variety of information and contrasting ideas (read different ideas and outlooks on life and topics).
- Be still (connect with the universe).
- Don't neglect your body.
- Approach all that you do with some playfulness and lightheartedness.
- Visualize what you want.
- Do a "brain dump" on paper to get all the clutter out of your mind.
- Set due dates for yourself.
- Meditate.
- Use positive affirmations.

Meditation

Meditation is the process of engaging in a mental exercise for the purpose of reaching a heightened level of spiritual awareness. Often, it is learning to focus on your breath as you inhale and exhale deeply. It's about true awareness of yourself, right down to your lungs expanding and constricting in that moment. Meditation develops attention and mindfulness, and allows you to tap into your energy more fully.

The benefits of meditation are as varied as the reasons people do it. For most people, the number one reason

they choose to meditate is to reduce stress. Meditation reduces the inflammation response caused by stress, which translates to reduced anxiety. It also reduces brain chatter, improves your focus, increases your feelings of being present, and helps you connect with your internal energy.

Emotional health has perhaps never been as serious an issue as it is today. People are feeling burnt out and needing ways to find themselves again. Meditation promotes emotional health and is a useful tool for helping to deal with depression. In fact, several studies have found that practicing meditation leads to improvement in depression symptoms. It also increases self-awareness by forcing you to be present in your body, allowing you to create a better understanding of yourself.

For those new to the process, you can take the Luhv+ Learn How to Meditate Challenge on the Luhv+ app. For now, here are some simple steps to help you start a wonderful (not to mention, healthy) new habit:

- Sit down in a quiet and comfortable place.
- Set a time limit (start small – 1-2 minutes, then work up to 3-4, then 5-10 minutes, and so on).
- Notice your body.
- Feel your breath.
- Don’t feel bad if your mind wanders.

It has been shown that meditating for just thirteen minutes a day can enhance attention and memory after eight weeks! It bolsters areas of the brain that assist with learning, memory, and cognitive and emotional

regulation. Meditation may even change the brain's structure to increase mental activity and agility. It stops pessimistic thought loops because it allows you to recognize negative thoughts and redirect them toward productive ones more easily.

But the benefits of meditation aren't just for the here and now. It also builds mental capacity and improved accuracy over time. Even as we age, people who meditate have increased concentration compared to those who don't.

Affirmations

Positive affirmations are positive statements you make to yourself. They are used to challenge negative and unhelpful thoughts and feelings. Affirming what we believe in positive ways reinforces our self-identity through the new narrative we are creating.

Many people feel strange about "talking to themselves," as they call it. But there is real science behind positive affirmations. They actually make changes to those areas of the brain that increase our happiness. Various studies have shown that they not only decrease stress, but also help you increase exercise, eat better, and achieve more in your day.

People often choose to use positive affirmations for motivation, encouraging positive change in their life, and boosting their self-esteem. And it really doesn't take a lot. Start with three to five minutes at least twice a day—when you wake up and before going to sleep. Choose a positive phrase and repeat it about ten times.

Don’t know where to start? Here are a few common affirmations:

- Good things are coming my way.
- I am doing my best, and that's good enough.
- Today is going to be a great day.
- I am capable of achieving my goals.
- I am happy. I see progress.
- I am amazing.
- I am grateful.

The important thing is finding what works for you and then making it a habit in your life. What inspires you? What allows you the time to reconnect with yourself? As always, you have the answers!

Time for Action

- Choose one to three positive affirmations and begin saying them twice a day.
- Take the Luhv+ Learn How to Meditate Challenge on the Luhv+ app.
- Meditate daily.
- Celebrate wins, no matter how big or small.

Time for Reflection

- *What positive affirmations can you start using? Why do they speak to you?*
- *How will you begin your daily meditation practice?*

Chapter 10

Mentorship

The Power of Not Doing it Alone

Mentorship is one of the fastest (and most efficient) ways to grow in your self-development journey. You don't have to do this alone … and you shouldn't.

Whether it's a student mentor, a personal mentor, or a professional mentor, they are key drivers for success. Mentors help you grow and develop to become the best version of yourself. This may involve helping you achieve your personal or career goals, introducing you to new ways of thinking, challenging your limiting assumptions, or sharing valuable life lessons.

Mentorship is a strong relationship between two people where the individual with more experience, knowledge, and connections has the ability and willingness to pass along what they have learned to others. They've seen the speedbumps and can help you navigate around them, while minimizing any potential damage.

At its foundation, mentorship is about the human connection—something that has been lacking in recent years. We need to reestablish it and connect with others

on a deeper, more meaningful level. Mentorship is one way to do so.

Remember, relationships always start with a connection. Mentorship does not begin with a formal application or request for someone to be your mentor. It's about the connection you have with someone you trust, who has the knowledge, information, and experiences to assist you on your journey, and someone who has the utmost integrity.

Your mentor will help you be more accountable. We are far more likely to let ourselves down than let others down. Why is that? It's often when we are lacking in self-love or are more concerned with others than ourselves. A mentor will help stop that line of thinking and remind you that you come first.

As a mentee, it's important to remember to respect their time and energy. Your mentor is investing in your success with no actual return on investment (ROI) other than seeing you succeed. But make no mistake, their time, just like yours and everyone else's, is extremely valuable. Make sure to always treat it that way because the quickest way to lose a mentor is to take advantage of their time.

To show them clearly that you respect them and their time, ensure you are using it wisely by always coming prepared to every call or meeting. Also, avoid asking them questions you could easily find the answers to yourself. Rather, ask them thought-provoking questions where their knowledge comes from their own personal or professional experiences, not a book or Google. Talk

about real challenges. Listen to recommendations. Ask questions if you don't understand them. Don't yes them to death if you really don't know what they are talking about.

Additionally, when they give you feedback—either positive or negative, embrace it. That's what they are there for! The true value of this relationship is getting the unbiased, honest truth, even when it is difficult for them to provide it (and for you to receive it). The key is recognizing that it is those difficult conversations that will propel you forward. You don't need someone to pat you on the back and congratulate you all the time. Your mentor is not your cheerleader. While they will always be cheering for you, there is a difference.

This difference is not only in the way you accept feedback, but also in the way you ask for it. You should be asking questions like –

- How can I improve?
- What would you have done in that situation?
- What if I did that instead of this?

These questions are vastly different than, "Didn't I do great?"

Ultimately, the best mentorships help both individuals. These are transformational mentorships. While most of the focus is definitely on the mentee, the mentor also gets something powerful out of the relationship. They have a desire to help support your growth, so when you grow by taking their advice, considerations, and recommendations, you are providing them with something they need, as well.

When you find the right mentor, are adaptable and willing to learn and grow, and are fully engaged, amazing things will happen. Continue to build trust in this valuable relationship and show them that you are doing what you need to do to improve. Consistently do what they tell you will do and be accountable for your intentions and actions. With your mutual desire for personal and professional growth, you will see the transformations much faster than if you were on your own.

Also, always keep in mind that if it is not the right fit, if you are not comfortable, or if this relationship is no longer serving you, it is time to move on. Don't waste your time or theirs. And just like everything else, staying in a situation that no longer serves you will not only not propel you forward, but actually push you back.

In finding the right person to serve as your mentor, look for someone who cares about your growth, not just someone who had the exact same career path. You should also share core values. Your mentor should be someone who sparks your curiosity and who makes you want to do better—someone who inspires you.

Remember, this is your life … always set the bar high.

Time for Action

- Is there anyone in your life who you look up to and feel as if they would help you as a mentor?
- Approach someone to ask if they would like to be your mentor.
- If you need a mentor, you can find one on the Luhv+ app.
- Develop a plan and schedule to keep the relationship professional.

Time for Reflection

- *What qualities do you want your mentor to have? Why?*
- *In what area of your life do you feel a mentor will be most beneficial?*

Chapter 11

Vision

Imagine the Possibilities

We are intentionally creating our future space. Whatever you want to show up in your world, you must first be the reflection of that possibility. Encourage yourself to feel the sensation of your possibilities and reflect that sensation onto yourself and onto others. In other words, be the change that you want to see in the world, with the intention of becoming more effective in less time.

Ask yourself: *Where do I want to be? Where do I see myself next year, in five years, in ten?*

If you want more love in your world, become authentically more loving. If you want deeper connections with others, become a little more vulnerable each day. If you want financial freedom for yourself, change your current relationship with money. You must be the reflection of what you want in your life. Then, you will attract everything in abundance.

You've likely heard that companies have vision statements. Those statements are usually at the core of everything those companies do—one of the most

important parts of the entire organization. So, if a company places that much value on a vision statement, shouldn't you for your life? After all, your life is your business.

A vision puts substance and context to your goals. It provides the destination to your journey. It tells you what you're working so hard for. And, when we face the roadblocks that we'll inevitably face, it makes it easier to navigate around them and stay your course. Detours are okay, as long as we find our way back. That's where vision helps—as if it's our own personal navigation system.

You vision commitment statement will also:

- Help you maintain focus.
- Set your expectations.
- Allow you to define your version of success.
- Identify what's most important to you.
- Find balance.

My suggestion is to write your own vision statement, considering both personal and professional paths. Look at the big picture. First, take some undisturbed time to think about your vision and where you want to be. Then, do an audit of all the various parts of your life—health, family, friends, work, relationships, spirituality, finance, habits, and anything else you spend time thinking about. Envision what your ideal life looks like in each of these individual parts and then, succinctly write it down. You now have your vision statement and your destination.

Before you can move forward, you must first make a commitment. Make a commitment to serve—yourself and others. Make a commitment to see out your vision because life never truly goes according to "plan." Rather, it goes according to vision. If you want success, it's going to start with that honest commitment. Success is simple. It's an intention fulfilled. And though it starts with a commitment, it is only achieved with consistency.

So, what are your intentions? Are you ready to fulfill those intentions? Can you do it consistently?

If you pull your current inspiration from this place—where you want to be instead of where you are today, you will shift the dynamic of your entire world. Remember, if you want success, it takes commitment and consistency. Your opportunity will come whether you are prepared for it or not. If you are prepared, it will reveal itself to you, but if you aren't, you won't see it that way.

Stay consistent. Stay dedicated. Stay motivated. Everything you want will show itself to you. You just have to be open and ready to receive it.

Pay attention to your life as it unfolds before you. You are creating it with your vision and your mindset—whether you realize it or not. And above all else, enjoy the ride—it's one beautiful journey!

Time for Action

- Do an audit of your life. Where are you happy and at peace? Where are you not happy?
- Create your vision statement.
- Create a vision board.

Time for Reflection

- *What do you want to include in your vision statement?*
- *What do you want to include in your vision board? Why?*

Resources

Luhv +
https://www.luhvplus.com

Luhv + Podcast
https://www.luhvplus.com/podcast

MogulElite Club
https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCH3XVewLV0frVTwYsWYKf6A

Acknowledgments

Thank you to everyone who has purchased this book.

Thank you to all of the members of the Luhv + Mailbox Millionaire Community.

Thank you to all the entrepreneurs and career professionals who see the importance of personal development.

About the Author

Shaun Crumméy (better known as Shon Crú-May (Phonetic Spelling)) is the Creator and Founder of the Luhv+ platform and community. The Luhv+ community is a place where creatives, entrepreneurs, and young business professionals gather to master their minds, elevate their lives, and simplify success. This is a place to come together to level-up careers, businesses, relationships, or any other area of life you desire. It is a safe, respectful, healing place to practice reaching your higher self, while pushing beyond your current limitations.

Shon has a Master of Arts and a Bachelor of Arts in Communications and Multi-Media. He is a leadership and business funding coach for new entrepreneurs, and a multi-media producer, artist, and philosopher.

Shon has helped to build strong, effective, inspiring company cultures and develop leaders to their highest potential. He specializes in becoming more effective in less time and alignment by helping people identify and achieve their personal goals. He does this by helping them cope with the issues that cause them anxiety, stress, and fear, while holding them accountable to push past their current limitations.

He believes in solid, genuine support for others and their journeys. He has gratitude for the progress and success of the people who choose to work, and discover, with him. And he looks forward toward a beautiful journey

with them by living a fruitful life with freedoms, wealth, love, healing, great health, deep inner connection, and positive energy vibrations, all in abundance.